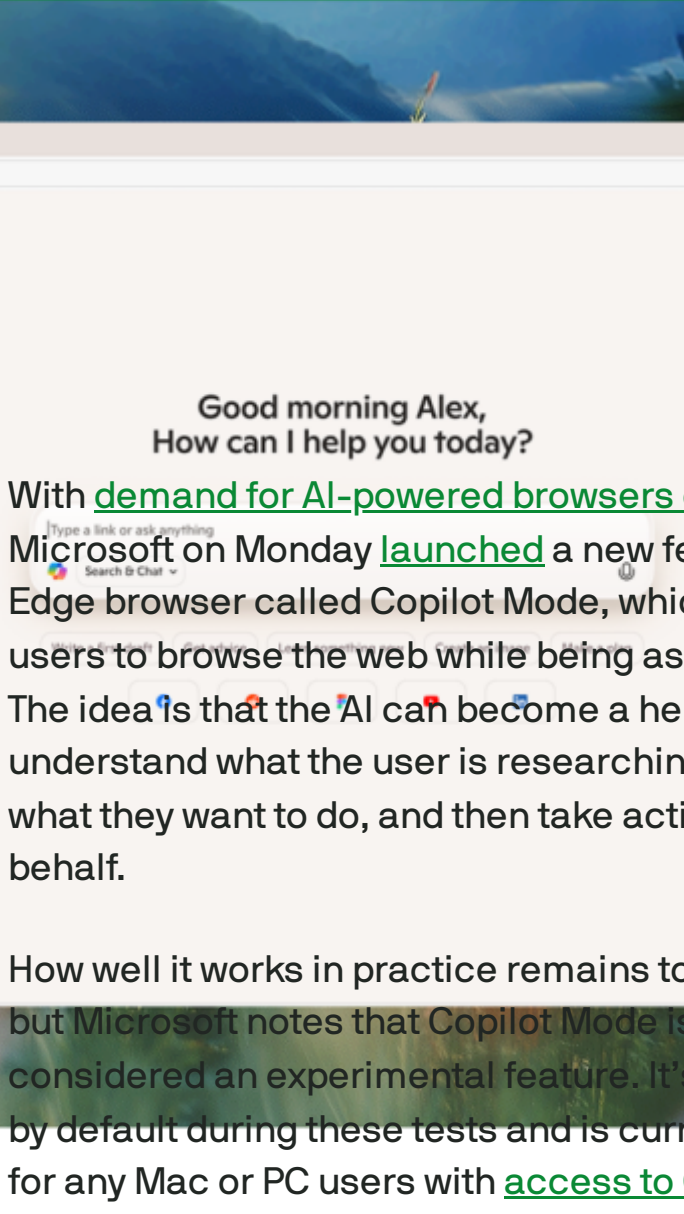


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AI



Microsoft Edge is now an
AI browser with launch of
‘Copilot Mode’



Good morning Alex,
How can I help you today?

The image shows a screenshot of the Microsoft Edge browser interface with Copilot Mode enabled. At the top, there's a search bar with the text "Type a link or ask anything" and "Search in Chat". Below that, a message from the AI assistant says "Good morning Alex, How can I help you today?". The background of the interface shows a scenic view of a mountain range under a blue sky.

With [demand for AI-powered browsers on the rise](#), Microsoft on Monday [launched](#) a new feature in its Edge browser called Copilot Mode, which allows users to browse the web while being assisted by AI. The idea is that the AI can become a helper that can understand what the user is researching, predict what they want to do, and then take action on their behalf.

How well it works in practice remains to be seen, but Microsoft notes that Copilot Mode is still considered an experimental feature. It's also opt-in by default during these tests and is currently free for any Mac or PC users with [access to Copilot](#).

IMAGE CREDITS: MICROSOFT

There are a few main components to Copilot Mode at launch, with more on the way.

Once enabled, Edge users will be presented with a new tab page where they can search, chat, and navigate the web with Copilot's assistance. When visiting a specific web page, they can also turn to Copilot for more help. For example, Microsoft shows how someone might ask the AI companion if a recipe they're viewing could be made vegan instead, and Copilot suggests substitutions.

This type of question is something users might ask an AI chatbot today, but this saves the step of having to paste in the content they want to reference.

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Or, someone could just ask the AI to simply present the recipe itself so they can skip reading through the “life story” that now accompanies so many online recipes.

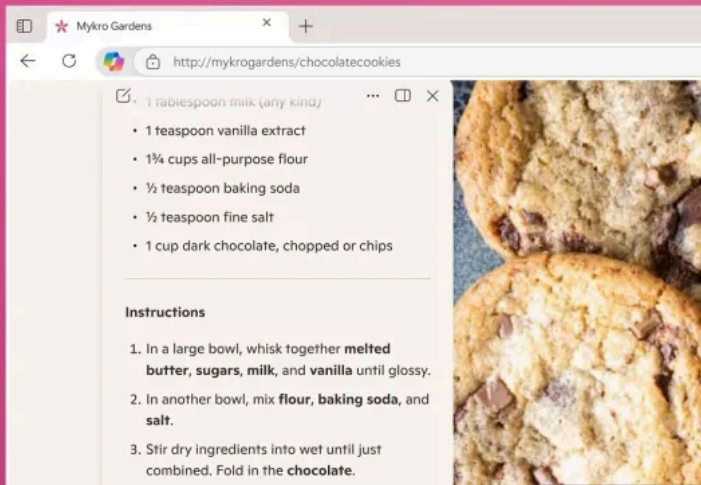


IMAGE CREDITS: MICROSOFT

In addition, Microsoft claims that Copilot can handle a variety of tasks on a user’s behalf, like booking appointments, creating shopping lists, and drafting content.

This “agentic” use of the web is the next big leap [in the AI browser race](#), but it’s unclear if consumer adoption will naturally follow. The goal, of course, is to make it easier to perform everyday tasks, like reserving a room on Booking.com or a flight via Kayak. However, chatting back-and-forth with an AI to go through the options and your needs isn’t necessarily better or faster than just doing it yourself, depending on your familiarity with the website in question.

Still, Copilot does allow for voice input, which could be handy for people who aren’t as tech-savvy when it comes to booking things online, or for those who have limited mobility. (Later on, Microsoft says users will be able to give Copilot the additional context it needs, like credentials or history, to manage more advanced actions, like bookings. For now, it’s a bit more manual.)

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What's more interesting, perhaps, is Copilot's ability to be a research companion. With the user's permission, Copilot can view all open tabs to understand what the person is browsing. This could be useful if they're doing some type of product comparison or online research, like pricing flights or hotels across multiple sites. Again, these are use cases for AI chatbots, but baking it into the browser could speed up the process of translating the user's needs to the digital helper.

In the future, Copilot will also prompt people to pick up where they left off on a project or something they're researching, by recommending next steps, Microsoft says.

The company stresses that Copilot will only be able to access someone's browsing content when they choose to allow it, and this will be made transparent to the end user with visual cues. However, the idea that you can now toggle on or off a feature that's able to view and listen to you while you search could leave some people unsettled.

Topics: [AI](#) [AI](#) [Browser](#) [Copilot](#) [Microsoft](#)



Sarah Perez

Consumer News Editor |

Sarah has worked as a reporter for TechCrunch since August 2011. She joined the company after having...

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IMAGE CREDITS: MICROSOFT

AI



Microsoft Copilot can now read your screen, think deeply, and speak aloud to you

Kyle Wiggers — 7:00 AM PDT · October 1, 2024

A week after announcing a wave of updates for its enterprise suite of [Copilot](#) AI-powered products, Microsoft is launching new Copilot capabilities on Windows for all users, including a tool that can understand and respond to questions about what's on your screen.

Refreshed Copilot apps for iOS, Android, Windows, and the web are rolling out today, and all feature a Copilot with a more “warm” and “distinct” style, as Microsoft describes it. Microsoft is also bringing the chatbot to WhatsApp, letting users chat with Copilot via DM, similar to the experience you get with other bots on Meta’s messaging platform.

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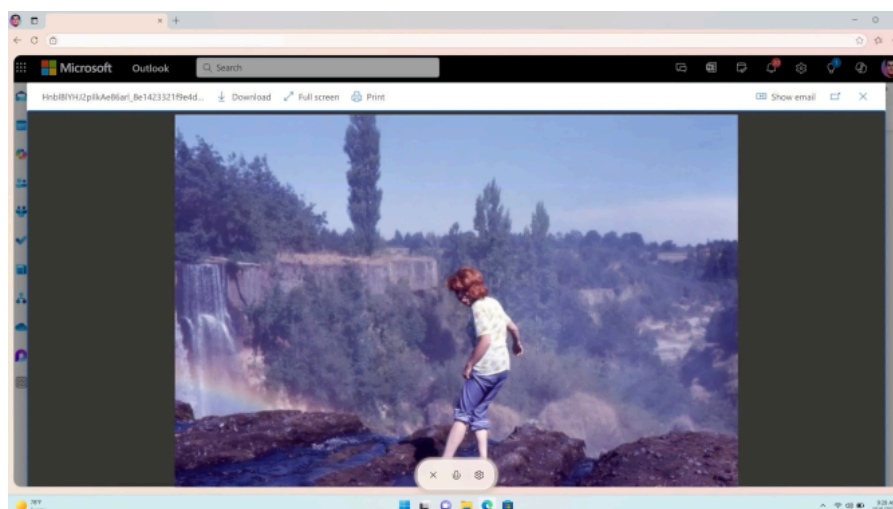
Copilot Vision

Copilot Vision has a view of what you're viewing on your PC — more specifically, a lens into the sites you're visiting with Microsoft Edge. Gated behind Copilot Labs, a new [Copilot Pro](#)-exclusive opt-in program for experimental Copilot capabilities, Copilot Vision can analyze text and images on web pages and answer queries (e.g., “What’s the recipe for the food in this picture?”) about them.

Vision, which can be pulled up by typing “@copilot” in Edge’s address bar, isn’t exactly a technical marvel. Google offers [similar search technology](#) on Android, and recently brought [bits and pieces of that tech](#) to Chrome as well.

But Microsoft suggests that Copilot Vision is more powerful and conscious of privacy than previous screen-analyzing features.

“Copilot Vision can ... suggest next steps, answer questions, help navigate whatever it is you want to do, and assist with tasks, all while you simply speak to it in natural language,” Microsoft wrote in a blog post shared with TechCrunch. “Imagine you’re trying to furnish a new apartment. Copilot Vision can help you search for furniture, find the right color palette, think through your options on everything from rugs to throws, and even suggest ways of arranging what you’re looking at.”



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No doubt eager to avoid [another round of bad press from AI privacy fumbles](#), Microsoft is stressing that Copilot Vision was designed to delete data immediately following conversations. Processed audio, images, or text aren't stored or used to train models, the company claims — at least not in this preview version.

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Copilot Vision is also limited in the types of websites that it can interpret. For the time being, Microsoft’s blocking the feature from working on paywalled and “sensitive” content, limiting Vision to a pre-approved list of “popular” web properties.

What does “sensitive” content entail, exactly? Porn? Violence? At this juncture, Microsoft wouldn’t say.

Accusations of circumventing paywalls with AI tools have landed Microsoft in legal hot water in the recent past. In an ongoing lawsuit, The New York Times [alleged](#) that Microsoft allowed users to get around its paywall by serving NY Times articles through the [Copilot chatbot on Bing](#). When prompted in a certain way, Copilot — which is powered by close Microsoft collaborator OpenAI’s models — would give verbatim (or close-to-verbatim) snippets of paid stories, according to The Times.

Microsoft said that Copilot Vision, which is U.S.-only at the moment, will respect sites’ “machine-readable controls on AI” — like rules that disallow [bots](#) from scraping data for AI training. But the company hasn’t said *precisely* which controls Vision will respect; there are [several](#) in [use](#). We’ve asked Microsoft for clarification.

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Design agents are here — Lovart launches the first end-to-end AI canvas for design

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Many major publishers have opted to block AI tools from trawling their websites not only out of fear their data will be used without permission, but also to prevent these tools from [sending their server costs soaring](#). If the current trend holds, Copilot Vision may not work on some of the web’s [top news sites](#).

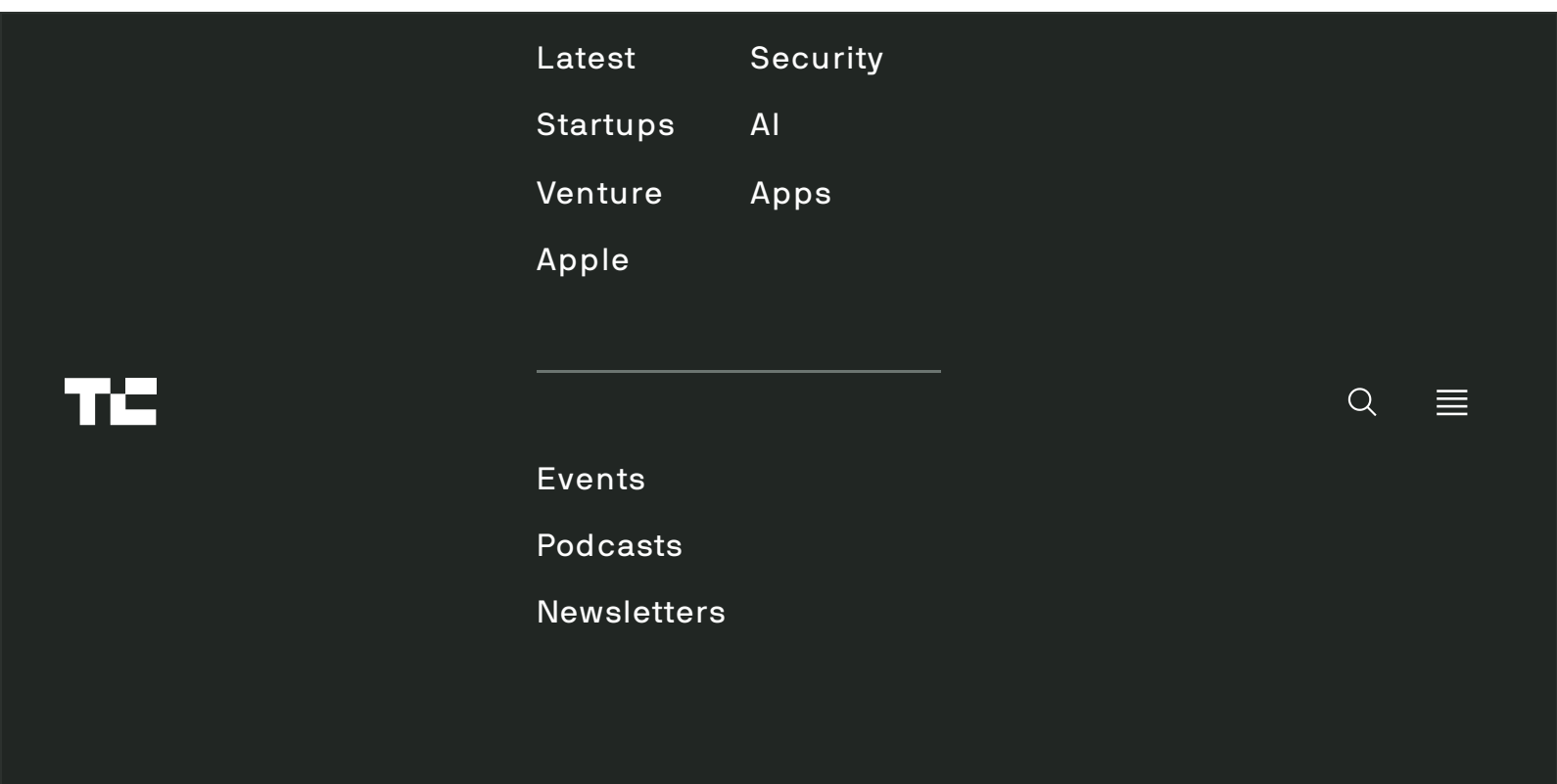
Microsoft said it’s committed to “taking feedback” to allay concerns.

“Before we launch broadly, we’ll continue to ... refine our safety measures and keep privacy and responsibility at the center of everything we do,” Microsoft said in the blog post. “There is no specific processing of the content of a website you are browsing [with Copilot], nor any AI training — Copilot Vision simply reads and interprets the images and text it sees on the page for the first time along with you.”

Think Deeper

As with Vision, Copilot’s new Think Deeper feature is an attempt to make Microsoft’s assistant more versatile.

Think Deeper gives Copilot the ability to reason through more complex problems, Microsoft said, thanks to “reasoning models” that take more time before responding with step-by-step answers.



Microsoft talked up Think Deeper’s potential quite a bit in its press materials. But assuming the model

underneath is o1, it will most certainly [fall short in some areas](#). We're curious to see what sort of enhancements Microsoft made to the base model and how forthcoming Think Deeper is about its limitations.

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Think Deeper will be available from today to a limited number of Copilot Labs users in Australia, Canada, New Zealand, the U.S., and the U.K.

Copilot Voice

A new Copilot feature generally available today is Copilot Voice (not to be confused with GitHub's [Copilot Voice](#)). Launching in English in New Zealand, Canada, Australia, the U.K., and the U.S. to start, Voice adds four synthetic voices, letting you talk to Copilot and have its responses be spoken aloud.



IMAGE CREDITS: MICROSOFT

Like OpenAI's [Advanced Voice Mode](#) for ChatGPT, Copilot Voice can pick up on your tone during conversations and respond accordingly, and you can interject at any point while Copilot Voice is

answering. A Microsoft spokesperson told me that the mode uses “the latest voice technology with new models that have been fine-tuned for the Copilot app.” What tech? Which models? On the specifics, mum’s the word.

One thing to be aware of: Copilot Voice has a time-based usage limit. Copilot Pro subscribers get more minutes but the number is “variable,” Microsoft told me, depending on demand.

Personalization

Copilot will soon become more tailored to your likes and preferences, Microsoft said, thanks to a new personalization setting.

When the setting is enabled, Copilot will draw on your past interactions and history, as well as your interactions with other Microsoft apps and services (Microsoft won’t say which) to recommend ways to use Copilot.

“This helps you get going,” Microsoft wrote in a blog post, “offering both a handy guide to Copilot’s useful features and conversation starters.”

Personalization in Copilot, which can be switched off in the Copilot settings menu on Windows, isn’t slated for the U.K. or EU anytime soon. But users elsewhere should begin to see the setting this afternoon.

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Microsoft and the EU have had a testy relationship where it concerns the company’s AI product rollouts. In May, the EU [warned](#) Microsoft that it

could be fined up to 1% of its global annual turnover under the bloc’s online governance regime, the Digital Services Act, after the company failed to respond to a request for information that focused on its generative AI tools.

A number of tech giants beyond Microsoft, including [Apple](#) and [Meta](#), have taken a cautious approach to launching AI tools in the EU, wary of running afoul of the bloc’s laws governing data privacy and model deployment.

“For users in the European Economic Area (EEA) and a limited number of other countries, we are evaluating options before offering this level of Copilot personalization for those users,” a Microsoft spokesperson told TechCrunch. “Some features will not be available in the EEA until a later date.”

Topics: [AI](#) [AI](#) [Apps](#) [Copilot](#) [Copilot Vision](#)

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Kyle Wiggers

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Kyle Wiggers was TechCrunch’s AI Editor until June 2025. His writing has appeared in VentureBeat and Digital...

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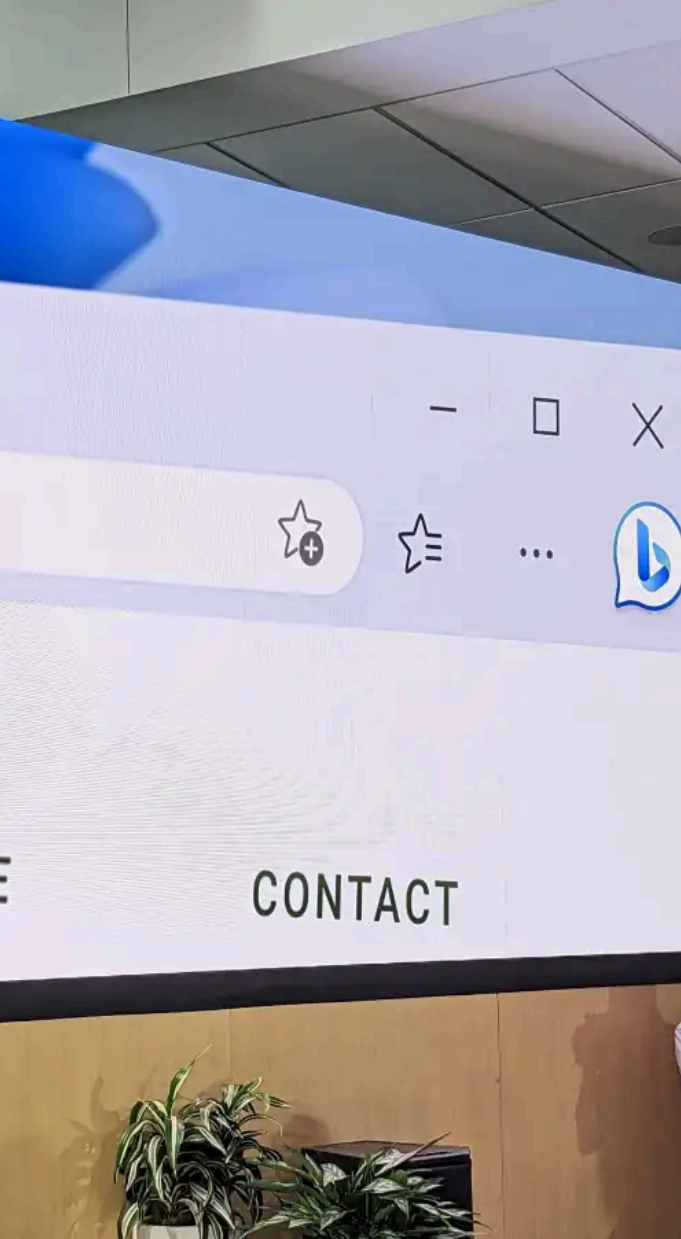


IMAGE CREDITS:
MICROSOFT EVENT PHOTO VIA TECHCRUNCH

AI



Microsoft's new Bing AI chatbot arrives in the stable version of its Edge web browser

Sarah Perez — 12:27 PM PDT · March 14, 2023

In addition to today's [launch of OpenAI's GPT-4](#), which [is now confirmed](#) to be the GPT model running in Bing, [Microsoft also announced](#) the stable version of its Edge web browser will now include the new Bing AI chatbot in a sidebar. The feature was first introduced at [Microsoft's AI press event in February](#) but was previously only available as a developer preview, not a public release.

With today's official unveiling of GPT-4, Microsoft is shipping the feature, which it calls the "Edge Copilot," in the stable version of its Microsoft Edge browser.

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Latest in AI



Just launched: Lovart, the AI design agent building entire campaigns in 3 minutes

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The update reimagines the concept of the sidebar, which previously hosted [Edge's "Discover" feature](#) to provide users with context about the page they're visiting. Now the new sidebar will offer an AI chatbot instead.

When users want to interact with the sidebar and the AI features, they'll just hover over the Bing icon in the toolbar to open the sidebar. When not in use, the sidebar can be automatically hidden.

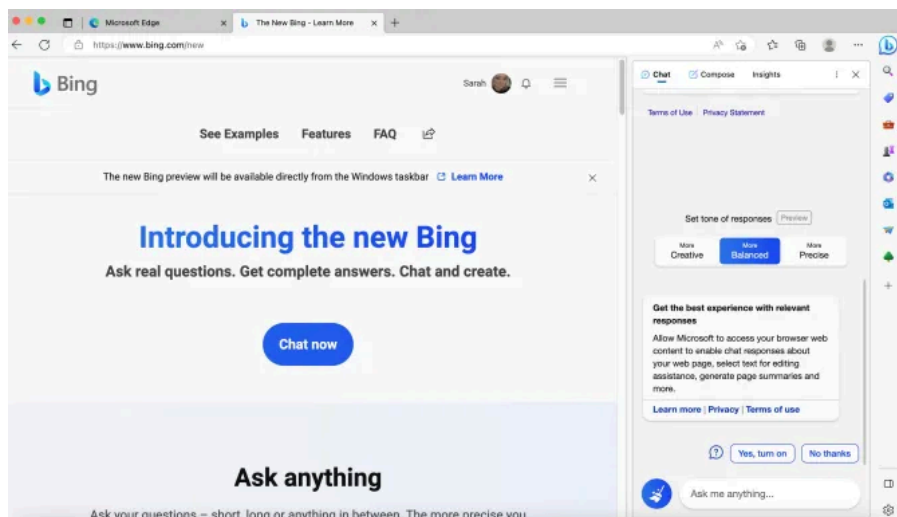


IMAGE CREDITS: SCREENSHOT OF EDGE BROWSER

While open, users can take advantage of the Edge Copilot, the AI feature that's capable of providing "intelligent suggestions and insights based on the context of the web page and the user's goals," Microsoft says.

As the company explained at its event, the AI chatbot had two main functionalities at launch — chat and compose. Together, these can help users do things like summarize lengthy web content, run comparisons or even create content in some cases.

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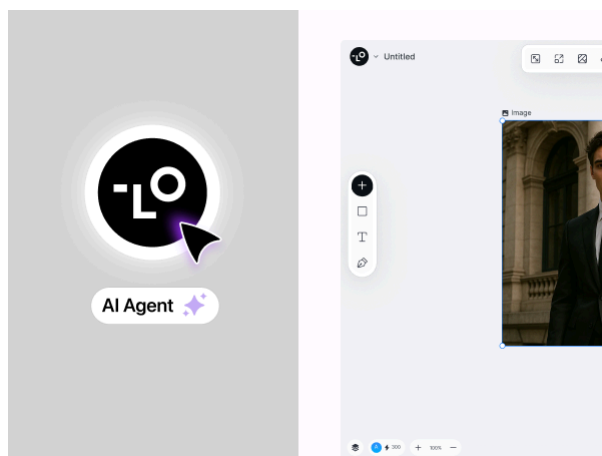
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For example, one of Microsoft's demos had shown the AI summarizing a company's financial statements — but unfortunately, [it got the numbers wrong](#), it was later revealed. In another, a developer asked the AI to write a snippet of code while researching tips on Stack Overflow. The AI was able to convert Python code to Rust. Microsoft even demonstrated the AI writing a LinkedIn post after a few prompts were given.

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Today, the company suggests that the AI Copilot could also be used to help users write better emails, search the web faster and learn new skills.

The productivity angle to AI has not been lost on the competition. Today, [Google unveiled](#) how it's incorporating AI into its own productivity solution, Workspace. Its plan involves incorporating generative AI within every part of Workspace, including helping users write emails in Gmail, write and edit documents in Docs, generate formulas in Sheets, capture notes in Meet and create text, images, audio, and video in Slides. Microsoft is expected to detail its answer to Google's move later this week.

Google goes all-in on bringing AI to Workspace



Google and Microsoft are locked in a head-to-head competition to bring as much generative AI to their productivity services as possible.

Only days ahead of Microsoft's "Future of Work" event, Google

today announced a sweeping update to Workspace that will bring its generative AI models to virtually every part of its productivity suite. In addition, [Continue reading](#)

While the sidebar is the most anticipated new Edge feature, it may be locked down by IT admins.

Microsoft notes admins will be able to control whether or not users have access to the sidebar in Edge at all — an important consideration, given that some companies, [including Walmart](#) and [Amazon](#), now have policies against sharing confidential company information with ChatGPT and other AI bots.

The AI sidebar isn't the only new feature coming to Edge with this release, however.

The company also says it's rolling out a new experience to the Microsoft 365 tab of the Edge Enterprise new tab page. This will now include a larger version of the Microsoft Feed, which includes more productivity content and moves cards with important emails, recent SharePoint sites, upcoming events, and to-do items over to the right-hand side of the tab.

Additionally, the browser will ship various security mode improvements and will support a new policy that controls whether or not the user's browsing history is deleted when the browser app is exited.

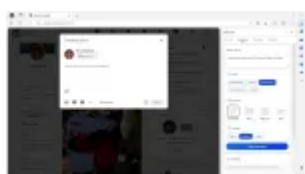
Microsoft says the stable version of its Edge web browser will roll out progressively over one or more days. The browser is available for both Windows and Mac platforms.

Microsoft's new Bing was using GPT-4 all along



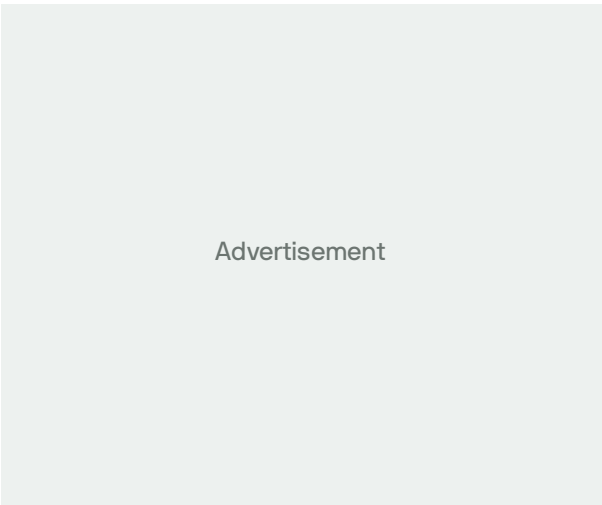
When Microsoft announced the new AI-enabled Bing, which it built on top of OpenAI's GPT models, neither company would confirm which version of GPT was being used beyond saying it was a next-gen version of the model that powered ChatGPT. Today, OpenAI announced GPT-4, a significant update to GPT-3.5. As it turns out, Bing was ... [Continue reading](#)

Microsoft's Edge web browser gets ChatGPT-like features



At a Microsoft press event today where the company demonstrated its new AI-powered search capabilities in Bing, the company also announced a new version of its Edge web browser that includes

AI technologies built in. With the new browser, web users are able to do things like summarize search results with AI's help and converse ... [Continue reading](#)



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